

## Forest Digital Learning



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# Glossary

**Basal area (G):** sum of the areas of sections of standing trees assumed to be circular and presumed to be cut to a height of 1.30 m or 1.50 m. It is expressed in m<sup>2</sup>/ha and characterises the density and competition between the trees in a stand.

**Cavity:** holes in the wood or sheltered places, damp or dry, containing potting soil or not, located in the trunk, crown or collar of the tree. The cavities are grouped into 4 groups: woodpecker lodge, potting soil cavity, insect orifices and galleries and concavities.

**Clearance: consists** of reducing competition from herbaceous or woody vegetation on regeneration. It is used from the first years up to a height of 3 m.

**Clear cut:** exploitation of all the trees in a plot or stand.

**Competing vegetation:** all herbaceous vegetation (bramble, fern, clematis, honeysuckle) competing with woody species.

**Competition:** competition between trees.

**Composition:** description of the species present in the stand.

**Continuous Cover Forestry (CCF):** Forestry that aims to optimise the management of forest ecosystems so that they fulfil their multiple socio-economic functions sustainably and profitably, primarily their function of producing high-quality timber.

To minimize ecological and economic risks, this type of forestry relies heavily on natural processes. The treatments applied are therefore based on canopy continuity and respect for the natural processes of forest growth and renewal.

**Cover:** a screen formed by the crowns of the trees in a stand. It is expressed by the surface of their projection on the ground.

**Canopy layer:** the upper part of the tree formed by branches and twigs that are carried by the trunk.

**DBH:** diameter at chest height.

**Defect of a standing tree:** a peculiarity developed on the tree that can affect its growth, shape and future quality. The analysis of these defects allows the forester to determine a general quality of the tree or by section.

**Dendromicrohabitat (DMH):** morphological singularity carried by a tree and used by species that are sometimes highly specialized, at least during part of their life cycle.

**Pre-commercial thinning:** An operation consisting of reducing the density of regeneration in favour of the best-formed stems, thereby limiting competition from seedlings of the same or different species. It is carried out on natural regeneration taller than 3 m.

**Designation:** An operation consisting of selecting and designating target trees. It is carried out on trees taller than 12 m.

It should be noted that pre-designation occurs earlier, as it involves physically identifying, at an early stage in natural regeneration, stems that are well-suited to the site, well-formed and have a future within the stand, so that future silvicultural operations can be concentrated solely on them.

**Diametrical structure:** Organization of the trees in a stand and their distribution by diameter over a given management unit.

**Dying tree:** tree with fatal symptoms. The intensity can vary from one tree to another, depending on the stage of the pathology.

**Gap:** an open area, with direct access to light, by removing trees whose height hinders the lighting on the soil.

**Girdling:** complete removal of the bark, liber and, in the growing season, cambium all around the trunk, to cause the gradual death of the tree.

**Habitat tree or tree of biological interest:** living or dead tree where one or more species live. It corresponds to the biotic (which relates to the action of living organisms) and abiotic (which relates to the action of non-living organisms: climate, soil, water, light, temperature) components of its immediate environment. The habitat tree bears dendromicrohabitats that are essential for these species.

**Increment:** volume of wood production over a specified period.

**Felling, tree marking:** an operation that consists, before cutting, of designating and marking with a hammer, trees intended to be sold, felled or reserved, whatever the nature of the cutting.

**Mature tree:** tree that has reached its exploitability dimension. This varies according to the species, the quality and the objectives of the hammering. A mature tree can be kept to renew the stand.

**Natural regeneration:** regeneration from seed companies by sowing or spontaneous rejects.

**Objective species:** species favoured in the stand receiving appropriate silvicultural care for their improvement or regeneration.

**Objective Tree:** This term refers to the silvicultural practice inherent in the CCF, which consists of silviculture of trees and not of stands.

**Pruning:** in the absence of natural pruning, artificial pruning is the process of cutting the low branches of objective trees and thus limiting the presence of knots, thus improving the quality of the wood. Pruning is carried out on quality trees that have reached a height of 6 m to 12 m.

**Regeneration:** The process of restoring a forest or part of a forest through human intervention involves sowing or planting.

**Releasing crown:** the action of removing trees for the benefit of an objective tree to free up its crown and ensure its proper development.

**Rotation:** the time interval between 2 successive passes of a cut in the same place.

**Seed plant:** isolated tree or tree in a stand, kept for its seed production in order to renew a stand.

**Site suitability:** assessment of the compatibility between the ecological characteristics of a forest site and the requirements of a tree species.

**Size class:** division of trees according to their size

**Stand storey:** the height stratum in which the trees in the stand are located. In an irregular stand, the trees have different heights and occupy several floors: dominant, intermediate and understory.

**Stand:** a section of the trunk of a standing tree.

**Support species:** species that play a cultural role to the benefit of objective species, in particular through the phenomenon of compression, i.e. the stress exerted on a tree by the presence of its neighbors, resulting in consequences on its growth and shape.

**Target dimension:** The maturity size of a tree. It is the target size threshold to be achieved for a particular species within the stand. This size varies according to the species, its quality, site conditions and marking objectives.

**Target tree:** This term refers to the silvicultural practice inherent in CCF, which consists of silviculture of trees and not of stands.

The target tree is good quality and must be in good site conditions. It must have a cylindrical and straight trunk, a developed crown, must be healthy, dominant and must not have low forks and branches.

The forester focuses his interventions primarily on these trees, which must be correctly distributed spatially in the stand.

**Typology:** a methodical approach consisting of defining or studying a set of types, to facilitate the analysis, classification and study of complex realities.